

HOUSE BILL 1155

By Lynn

AN ACT to amend Tennessee Code Annotated, Title 39;  
Title 40; Title 44; Title 47 and Title 53, relative to  
cell-cultured food products.

BE IT ENACTED BY THE GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE:

SECTION 1. Tennessee Code Annotated, Title 53, Chapter 7, Part 2, is amended by  
adding the following new section:

(a) As used in this section, "cell-cultured food product":

(1) Means a food product intended for use as human food that is  
produced without slaughter by growing, in a controlled environment, cells  
harvested from species amenable to the Federal Meat Inspection Act (21 U.S.C.  
§ 601 et seq.) or Poultry Products Inspection Act (21 U.S.C. § 451 et seq.), or  
cells harvested from shellfish species or big game, game birds, or fish, as those  
terms are defined in § 70-1-101; and

(2) Includes food or a food additive, as those terms are defined in § 53-1-  
102, produced in the manner described in subdivision (a)(1) and used as an  
ingredient or component in a food.

(b) A person shall not sell or distribute, or import for sale or distribution into this  
state, cell-cultured food products.

(c)

(1)

(A) If the commissioner believes that a person is violating or has  
violated subsection (b), then the commissioner must notify the person, in  
writing, of the violation. The notice must include, at a minimum:

(i) The information supporting a finding of the violation and a statement that the person has ten (10) days following service of the notice to submit a written request for a hearing or the commissioner's findings become final; and

(ii) A stop sale order, if the finding becomes final in accordance with subdivision (c)(1)(A)(i) or after a hearing held in accordance with subdivision (c)(1)(B).

(B) A hearing held pursuant to subdivision (c)(1)(A)(i), and an appeal from a final decision after a hearing, must be held in accordance with the Uniform Administrative Procedures Act, compiled in title 4, chapter 5.

(d) If the commissioner finds that a person violated subsection (b), then:

(1) The person is subject to a fine of one million dollars (\$1,000,000); and

(2) The commissioner may revoke the person's permit for a food establishment if the person, or an employee of the person's food establishment, is found to have violated subsection (b) in connection with the food establishment.

(e) In addition to the penalties provided under subsection (d), a cell-cultured food product that is imported, sold, or distributed in violation of subsection (b) is subject to forfeiture pursuant to title 40, chapter 33, part 2.

SECTION 2. The department of agriculture shall promulgate rules to effectuate this act. The rules must be promulgated in accordance with the Uniform Administrative Procedures Act, compiled in title 4, chapter 5.

SECTION 3. This act takes effect July 1, 2025, the public welfare requiring it.